Notes on Data Exchange Between Regional Clinics

Regional clinics keep their records in several different systems. Some of these systems were installed more than fifteen years ago. Others were bought recently and follow newer standards.

When a patient moves from one clinic to another, the receiving clinic often has to type the history again by hand. This takes time and introduces errors. The working group was asked to study how the clinics could improve the interoperability of their records without replacing every system at once.

The group met six times during the spring. It interviewed staff at nine clinics and reviewed the formats each system can export. Its main recommendation is a shared summary format that every system can read and write.

A small pilot will start in two clinics in the autumn. If it succeeds, the format will be offered to the remaining clinics next year.